

The 'slow-death' experience and the new metronome

Jasprit Bumrah's slower balls and Akash Deep's seam movement against Bangladesh showcase a **fast-bowling blend** of innovation and tradition. The numbers tell us the hows and whys.

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In the recent series against Bangladesh, Indian pacers managed to match their spin counterparts for only the second time in a home Test series by taking an equal number of wickets — 20 each.

This feat highlighted a dynamic and effective strategy from the Indian fast-bowling unit. The charge was led by Jasprit Bumrah, who claimed 11 wickets, and he was ably supported by Akash Deep, who contributed with some crucial spells to end with five wickets.

Their success can be attributed to a mix of skill sets that combined the unorthodox with the fundamental. Bumrah's deceptive slower balls and Akash's relentless use of seam movement showcased a modern blend of fast bowling that leverages both innovation and tradition, allowing them to effectively navigate conditions that have historically been more favourable to spinners.

Bumrah's unconventional approach

Bumrah has become a household name due to his unique bowling action and his ability to adapt to different formats. Mushfiqur Rahim, a veteran Bangladeshi batter known for his competence against spin, found himself on the receiving end of a rare and unexpected delivery from Bumrah.

On the fifth day of the second Test, Bumrah unleashed a 125 kmph off-cutter that confounded



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